

PROGRAM ASSESSMENT REPORT

Tracking data

CIM code	MAS-IDMT / MS-SDL
Program name	Master of Design Methods (MDM) – now called Master of Science in Strategic Design Leadership (MS-SDL)
Assessment plan year	2024/2025
Program assessment coordinator	Matt Mayfield (mayfield@id.iit.edu)
Year of Current Assessment Plan	2024
No assessment this year per plan	☐
LO(s) assessed	Goal 3: Understand how to improve the capacity of responsible design and innovation in an organization
Presented at program authority meeting date:	ID Faculty meeting Oct 16, 2025

Methodology/ Evidence reviewed

This assessment cycle builds on the structure established in the previous year and focuses on one of the three primary learning objectives for the MDM/MS-SDL program:

Goal 3: *Understand how to improve the capacity of responsible design and innovation within an organization.*

Evaluation centered on the analysis of final presentations from courses most closely aligned with this objective. While many courses contribute to developing these competencies, assessment was limited to required courses to ensure consistency and comparability, in accordance with the Fall 2024 assessment plan.

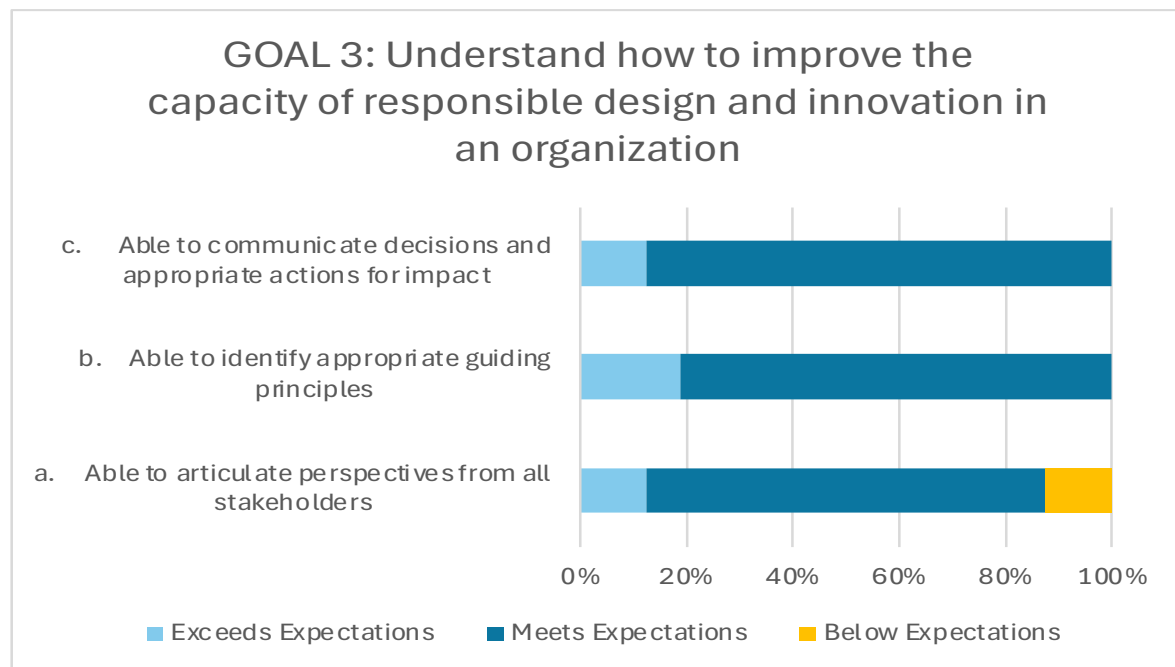
One of the two selected courses, **IDN 540 Implementing Innovation**, lost track of final project submissions. This issue resulted from the program's migration from Google to Microsoft platforms and incomplete use of the Canvas system. The faculty member involved has been advised on proper procedures to prevent recurrence.

Although program enrollment remains small, the evidence collected provides meaningful insight into areas of strength and opportunities for refinement. Artifacts were drawn from **IDN 566 Strategic Communication** final presentations and evaluated using the program's standardized rubric.

Learning Goal Assessed	GOAL 3: Understand how to improve the capacity of responsible design and innovation in an organization	
Assessment rubric	Outcomes to evaluate for each piece of evidence: - Able to articulate perspectives from all stakeholders - Able to identify appropriate guiding principles - Able to communicate decisions and appropriate actions for impact	Assessment Categories: <i>Below expectations:</i> No theories/methods from the course referenced or applied <i>Meeting expectations:</i> Theories/methods from the course applied, but with uneven or limited success <i>Exceeding expectations:</i> Comprehensive and appropriate application of theories/methods covered in the course
Evidence/Artifact source(s)	IDN 566 Strategic Communication final presentations/projects	
Location of evidence/artifacts	Evidence (Microsoft Teams)	

Results

Summary of findings



Description of findings

The benchmark for program performance is that at least 80% of evaluated artifacts meet or exceed expectations. Based on the reviewed evidence, this threshold was achieved, indicating satisfactory attainment of Learning Goal 3.

While the small sample size limits broader inference, the findings suggest that students demonstrate a clear understanding of stakeholder perspectives and are increasingly adept at framing decisions and actions that promote responsible innovation. Continued attention to systematic data capture across all required courses will strengthen the reliability of future assessments.

Continuous Improvement, CI, plans

Prior CI plan impact

☐ *no previous CI plans available*

The previous improvement plan emphasized closer monitoring of student readiness at program entry. Results from this cohort suggest progress in addressing prior concerns. Although the overall number of enrolled students remains too small to support strong statistical confidence, no further decline in incoming student preparedness has been observed. The program will continue to monitor readiness indicators, especially as it transitions to a fully asynchronous and online format.

This cycle's CI plan

☐ *After consideration and presentation to the program authority, no CI plans are recommended*

Although there are no specific actions to take based on the findings of this cycle, the program is currently in transition to an asynchronous delivery model. Each course, in collaboration with online learning partners, will undergo review to ensure that specific learning objectives and measurable outcomes are embedded throughout the lessons. This review will also improve the precision of learning data collection and alignment across courses.

Assessment Process Recommendations

The collection and management of assessment artifacts have improved with the adoption of the Canvas platform and greater faculty awareness of assessment protocols. A minor issue occurred with one adjunct faculty member; corrective guidance has been provided, and the problem has been resolved.

To maintain progress, faculty are encouraged to continue consistent use of Canvas as the primary repository for assessment artifacts. Periodic check-ins at midterm and semester end will further ensure complete data capture for each assessment cycle.

Assessment Plan for Upcoming Cycle

For the next assessment cycle AY 2025/2026, we will review learning goals, per the current assessment plan listed here:

Goal 1: Identify opportunities through research and human-centered design principles

- a. Able to organize analysis, principles, and implications
- b. Able to develop model(s) of understanding through a human-centered lens
- c. Able to define opportunities with a critical and constructive point(s) of view

Looking at the evidence from the following courses:

- IDN 508 Principles & Methods of User Research
- IDX 508 Modes of Human Experience